

98%+

GROSS MARGINS (BYOK)

36 mo

RUNWAY AT \$1M RAISE

\$0

LLM INFERENCE COST

What Is It

GuardSpine is an open-source governance layer that creates tamper-proof audit trails for every code change -- whether written by humans or AI. It is not a code review tool. It is insurance against the question: **"Who is liable when AI-generated code causes a breach?"**

Who Buys It

Primary buyer: CISO or Chief Compliance Officer at companies with 500+ engineers in regulated industries (finance, healthcare, insurance, legal).

End users: Developers install it as a GitHub Action in 5 minutes. They keep working the way they already work. The CISO gets the dashboard and evidence.

Pricing

TIER	PRICE	FOR
Free	\$0/mo	Open-source GitHub Action, full review engine, unlimited repos
Starter	\$499/mo	Cloud dashboard, Slack alerts, evidence management, 10 repos
Team	\$2,000/mo	Custom rubrics, Jira + Teams, compliance reports, unlimited repos
Org	\$12,000/mo	Multi-team RBAC, ServiceNow, SSO/SAML, dedicated CSM
Enterprise	Custom	On-prem/airgap, SLA, compliance consulting

BYOK model: Customers bring their own AI model API keys. GuardSpine never touches inference costs. Gross margins: 97-99%.

Why Now

1. AI is writing code faster than anyone can review it. 65% of PRs ship with minimal or zero review (Graphite, 2025). AI-generated code has 1.7x more defects (CodeRabbit) and 2.74x more security issues (Veracode).

2. Regulations are closing in. EU AI Act enforcement begins August 2026 (fines up to 7% of global turnover). DORA enforceable since January 2025 (2% of turnover). SOC 2 auditors are asking for code-level governance evidence.

3. Nobody else does this. Vanta and Drata prove infrastructure is configured correctly. Snyk and Checkmarx find vulnerabilities. Neither proves that AI-generated code was governed before reaching production. That is the gap.

ROI Snapshot

16,337%

ENGINEERING ROI (TEAM TIER)

1,999%

COMPLIANCE ROI (ORG TIER)

~2 days

PAYBACK PERIOD

AUDIENCE	KEY METRIC	ANNUAL VALUE
Engineering (50 devs, Team tier \$19.2K/yr)	Prevented defects + recovered review time	\$3.1M savings
Compliance (200 devs, Org tier \$120K/yr)	Audit automation + regulatory risk reduction	\$2.5M savings

Proof of Interest

SIGNAL	WHO	SIGNIFICANCE
LANDING PAGE SIGNUP	Andy Ellis -- ex-CSO Akamai (20yr), Partner at YL Ventures (cybersecurity VC), CISO Series podcast co-host, CSO Hall of Fame	Cybersecurity VC partner and 20-year CISO signed up within 48 hours of launch -- unprompted
COLD REPLY	Brent Foster -- VP Eng, TD Bank	Top-5 NA bank VP responded to unknown founder's cold email asking technical differentiation questions
DD QUESTIONS	Phil Venables -- Ballistic Ventures, ex-CISO Google Cloud	Cybersecurity-focused VC asked team/pipeline/ICP questions independently
RESPONSE RATE	4.8% cold response rate	Industry average: 1-3% for unknown founders selling pre-revenue product

What is missing: Zero paying customers. Zero pilots. This is the gap between "interesting project" and "investable business." Landing pages live since Feb 22, 2026.

The Team

NAME	ROLE	KEY CREDENTIALS
David Youssef	CEO (full-time)	Vision, 1:1 sales, domain expertise
Igor Malovitsa	CTO (full-time)	MSc Experimental Nuclear Physics (4.0 GPA). 8.5yr Senior Eng at DataArt. CTO obox.systems (Rust). Published O(1) hash collision attacks + shipped fix upstream. Rust/C++/WASM/Python.
Kristen Hengst Smith	GTM Advisor	Product-to-market experience, angel network
Chris Hood	Advisor	Noematic AI framework, Google connections

Validation Strategy: Three Angles

ANGLE	PARTNER	WHAT IT VALIDATES
Enterprise	Ishwar Chandrasekharan (Z-Inspection, IBM)	Internal friction and risk thresholds for governance tool adoption at Fortune 100
Government / Standards	Jacob Friedman (G7/NIST, Permion)	SBOM complementarity, airgap/offline requirements, gov procurement pathways
Direct Buyer	CISO/CCO outreach in regulated industries	Buy-trigger validation, pricing sensitivity, ICP confirmation

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